MGU UGP(HONOURS) REGULAR EXAM – MARCH- 2026

FOURTH SEMESTER

MG4DSCPHL200- ANCIENT AND MEDIEVAL WESTERN PHILOSOPHY

QP-CODE-25901423 ANSWER KEY

PART A

1. Anaximenes
2. A form of argumentative dialogue based on asking questions to stimulate critical thinking and there by illuminate ideas.

3. Character is a stable disposition developed through habitual actions aimed at achieving eudaimonia.

4. Argument from design, argument from motion.

5. Aristotle admits the dualistic nature through his agreement that Ideas are ultimate realities. Matter or the particulars are also considered as having reality with a secondary states.

6. Because it is fundamentally a kind of interactive dialogue to stimulate critical thinking among them.

7.Fundamental, unchanging and defining nature of an entity which make a thing what it is.

8. According to St. Thomas Aquinas, evil is not a positive force but rather a privation of good or absence of a perfection.

9. Because it marked a deliberate shift from mythological, divine -based explanations to logical enquiry, observation and natural causes for understanding the universe.

10. “The unexamined life is not worth living”. He said that the moral virtue requires constant self-reflection.

11.Formative period, period of scholasticism, decline of scholasticism.

12. Moral evil is the suffering and harm caused by purposeful human actions,inactions or free will choices.

Part B

13. Pythagorians made Greek philosophy by merging mathematics, mysticism and ethics.founding a way of life based on numbers rather not just tools for measurements-metaphysics of numbers-musical harmony-the transmigration of souls-rigorous self-discipline etc.

14. Allegory of the cave depicts chained prisoners in a dark cave-relation of it with human ignorance accepting sensory illusions as truth-while true education enables them to understanding reality-the role of knowledge etc.

15. Aristotle defines the fundamental independent reality that exists on its own .What it is of a thing-primary substance-secondary substance-hylomorphism(hyle-matter) and mophe (form or essence)etc.

16. Aquinas distinguished both reason and faith which are two source of knowledge originate from God so cannot contradict one another-Reason relies on empirical observation -logic to understand world-complementary to each other etc.

17. Anaximander -pre- socratic philosopher-earth is cylinder shaped body-free floating nature-positioned at an equal distance from the center of the universe.

18. Plato distinguishes between appearance or opinion and genuine knowledge or epistme -sepeating sensory world and intelligible world-appearance are changing-subjective perceptions of material world etc.

19. Logic-theoretical science-practical science-productive science-etc.

20. Augustines theory of knowledge centers on his concept of divine illumination -humans need Gods light to understand eternal truths beyond sense perception-lower reason-higher reason-divine illumination etc.

21. St. Anselm ,medieval philosopher- “God is a being that which no greater can be conceived”- the concept of existence -God is a necessary existence-so we cannot able to conceive Him as not existing -existence is a state of the highest perfection-to think God as non-existent is to be lead self- contradiction etc.

22.Give an introduction to early Greek philosophy-scholars-Rhetoric-subjectivity-relativism-prominence of persuation over factual knowledge-Protogoras-man is the measure of all things-Truth is relative to individual perceptions etc.

PART-C

23. Heraclitus-universe is in a state of flux-change or becoming is the only reality-dynamic process-becoming rather than being-concept of motion-river analogy-one cannot step into the same river twice-fire as the metaphor -opposed to Parmenides theory of being etc.

24. Theory of Ideas or Forms-theory of substance-features of reality-characteristics of Ideas -its connection with particulars and universals etc.

25. Give an account of Aristotelian substance-theory of form and matter-hylomorphism-causation-four causes-formal, material, efficient and final cause in detail-potentiality and actuality- unmoved mover etc.

26. Introduce medieval philosophy-scholasticism-general features-influence of theo -centrism- role of theology-role of revelation-main periods-formative-scholastic and

decline of scholasticism- main thinkers at this times-Proofs for the existence of God etc.